

a friend's aid. Unlike the hanumen, their frequent partners in crime, the tanuki can dish it out and take it, and their loyalty is beyond reproach. Nowhere in the world is safer than a tanuki's territory, assuming one is welcome there.

Appearance: Tanuki are often thickset in hotei form, squat but strong fireplugs with a coating of fat that they'll tell you is for the winter months. In their animal form, they are large raccoon dogs, with thick brown fur highlighted with distinctive striping. Their wani form is a combination of the two, standing perhaps five feet tall at the most, muscle overlaid with fur. When they employ the Mask of Shintai, they more resemble a wolverine than a raccoon dog, all teeth and claws and bristling fur, ready to maul anything that comes near.

Lifestyle: Tanuki are often homebodies, preferring their territory to traveling to new and unseen territories. They've traditionally lived like peasants, and many still do, but as cities expand more and more find themselves having to acclimate to the modern rat race of society. While not so naturally skilled with shapechanging as myth might suggest, the more studious among tanuki often learn the first rungs of Nei Tan, if only to expand their opportunity for tricking others.

Fortune: Metal

Luck: Tanuki are able to make themselves supernaturally trustworthy. With the expenditure of a point of Yugen, the tanuki's words seem to be the unvarnished truth, even if the statement is patently false (convincing the unlucky target that it's a fine day for sunbathing when snow sits a foot deep outside, for example). Supernatural abilities can break through this power of suggestion with an appropriate roll, and even mortals will quickly realize they've been had, but that's often all the tanuki needs.

Curse: It is all but impossible to dissuade a tanuki. Once a tanuki has made up his mind, the player must succeed at a Willpower roll (difficulty 8) to change plans.

Wani Powers: A tanuki's last resort in a scrap, her wani form is tougher and much more dangerous than either of her other forms. She enjoys +1 Stamina while in this form, while her claws inflict Strength + 1 damage, and her jaws inflict Strength + 2 damage.

Chu-ih-yu

When it is time for justice to be meted out, it is often the chu-ih-yu who make themselves known. Unflinchingly brave and wholly dedicated to retribution, they allow nothing to stand in the way of the "eye for an eye" principle. While not sagacious, they are renowned for impartiality, and are often called to serve in arbitration — though, once the decision has been made, woe to he who does not uphold it!

Appearance: Inevitably tall and overbearing, chu-ih-yu stand out even in their hotei form. When they take their wani form, their skin becomes a silvery metal that is nonetheless as flexible as skin, with angular features that seem more die-cast than sculpted. Their hair is white, and almost universally worn long, and their eyes glow brilliantly. When they employ the Mask of Shintai, they become gaunt, almost skeletal, but no

less terrifying, their glistening steel teeth frozen in a rictus of fury as they loom over the unfortunate to whom they have chosen to show this visage.

Lifestyle: Chu-ih-yu gravitate to positions of authority, particularly in law enforcement and the wider justice system. However, in some situations they may also choose to work outside the law, particularly if they consider the local or national government to be unjust. In either case, they make spectacular (if somewhat dangerous) enforcers. Many gravitate to the traditionalist Li Shen Court, and serve in the Ministry of Metal.

Fortune: Metal

Luck: No boldfaced lie may pass in earshot of a chu-ih-yu — he can smell the untruth on the wind. Should cleverness and dissembling be used to mask the lie, the chu-ih-yu still enjoys a +2 bonus to any roll to detect it.

Curse: Chu-ih-yu cannot knowingly lie, unless the player spends a Willpower point.

Wani Powers: No lesser metal may harm the sacred, iron-hard flesh of the chu-ih-yu, who automatically soak their Stamina in levels of damage from any metal source (including swords and bullets).

Chu Jung

Outgoing and quick with their words, the chu jung look forward and act passionately, as the flame gives light and heat. Unlike the legalistic chu-ih-yu, chu jung may give a measure of respect to the letter of the law, but will bend its spirit freely. Indeed, they take great delight in doing so, and are the leading edge of change among the courts of the Shinma — when they aren't overreacting to mistreatment or insults. Fire can burn, too, and the temper of the chu jung is legendary among the Shinma for its ferocity and the speed with which it seizes them.

Appearance: Chu jung run hot in hotei form, warm enough that even proximity is enough to feel their heat. When they shed this mask to assume their wani form, their skin deepens to a magnificent red, steam rising from their bodies as flame courses through their eyes. In this form, chu jung prefer flowing garments and the color gold. When they employ the Mask of Shintai, flames lick from their every pore, their eyes blazing nearly bright enough to blind onlookers.

Lifestyle: Chu jung will often settle into positions that allow them to keep an eye on those around them, and especially to pry into their affairs. More than any of the kamuii, they are likely to maintain strong ties to the human world. Mortal firefighters are a particular favorite, and many Chu Jung will go to great lengths to protect them.

Fortune: Fire

Luck: Chu jung, embodied flame itself, naturally oppose the darkness, and enjoy a -2 difficulty to Perception rolls. Quick as flame itself, they receive the same benefit for rolls involving insight and leaps of logic.

Curse: Insults and challenges stoke the furnace within a chu jung's heart. They cannot let insults pass unremarked unless the player spends a Willpower point.